license and studies the old photo of you with that bad haircut you thought was pretty cool at the time. After a few seconds of quizzical stares, he eventually accepts that it really is you, and you can begin the test.

> **EXPLANATION** Most APIs need to identify the clients that are interacting with them. As these fictional interactions illustrate, there may be different ways of identifying your API clients that are appropriate in different situations. As with Alice, sometimes there is a long-standing trust relationship based on a history of previous interactions, while in other cases a more formal proof of identity is required, like showing a driving license. The examiner trusts the license because it is issued by a trusted body, and you match the photo on the license. Your API may allow some operations to be performed with only minimal identification of the user but require a higher level of identity assurance for other operations.

You failed the test this time, so you decide to take a train home. At the station you buy a standard class ticket back to your suburban neighborhood, but feeling a little devil-may-care, you decide to sneak into the first-class carriage. Unfortunately, an attendant blocks your way and demands to see your ticket. Meekly you scurry back into standard class and slump into your seat with your headphones on.

When you arrive home, you see the light flashing on your answerphone. Huh, you'd forgotten you even *had* an answerphone. It's Alice, inviting you to the hot new club that